

20,000 AFRICAN ELEPHANTS ARE KILLED EACH YEAR FOR THE ILLEGAL IVORY TRADE



THE AFRICAN ELEPHANT POPULATION HAS DROPPED BY 90% OVER THE LAST 100 YEARS

ANIMALS IN DANGER

African forest elephant

⚠ IUCN status: endangered

📊 Population estimate: 100,000

African savanna elephant

⚠ IUCN status: vulnerable

📊 Population estimate: 315,000

Asian elephant

⚠ IUCN status: endangered

📊 Population estimate: 20,000–40,000

Habitats at risk

From the savannas, open woodlands, and shrublands of Africa to the grasslands and humid forests of Asia, elephants are a key part of their ecosystems. But human intervention is leading to the destruction of their natural habitats, putting them at risk of extinction.

INDIA

Bay of Bengal

CHINA

South China Sea

Asian elephant

In mainland Asia—including India—elephants live in grassland or forest. Their natural ranges are shrinking, leaving them access to only 15 percent of their original range.

Domed head

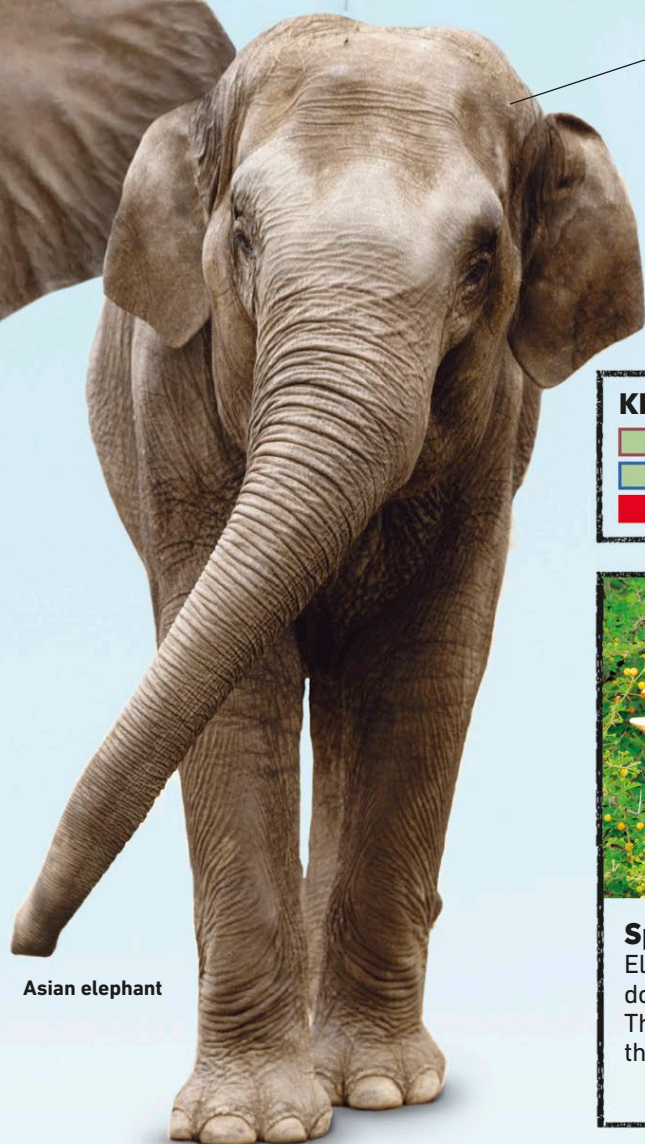
Asian elephants are smaller than their African cousins and have a two-domed, rather than single-domed, forehead. Their skin is also smoother and hairier than the rough skin of African elephants.

KEY

- African forest elephant
- African savanna elephant
- Asian elephant

Smaller sizes

Asian elephants living in forests in Borneo are shorter than those on the mainland. They are sometimes called Bornean pygmy elephants.

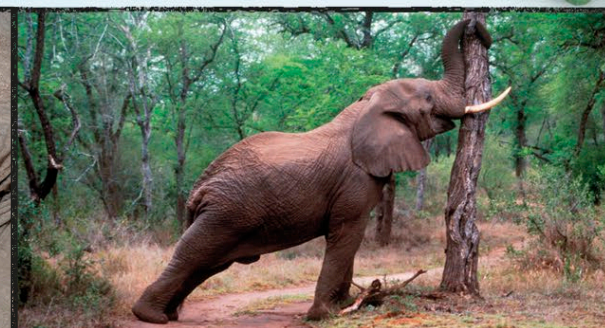


Asian elephant



Spreading seeds

Elephant herds can flatten foliage and tear down trees, but they also help scatter seeds. They eat ripe fruit from their favorite trees, and the seeds pass out in piles of fertilizing dung.



Tree browsers

Elephants are not picky eaters—they browse on leaves, seeds, fruit, flowers, grass, and tree bark. They will even push over trees to get to the nutritious roots deep underground.